Prepared for BlackRock

Aladdin Studio, learned with AI

What public sources show about the product, where BlackRock is heading, and the quick wins for marketing Studio

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Independent analysis compiled from public sources with AI agents. It was not produced, reviewed or endorsed by BlackRock.

Executive summary

An outsider with AI agents and about a day can assemble a detailed, sourced picture of Aladdin Studio from BlackRock's own specifications, pages and recordings, plus filings and code. This is what it looks like, what it says about direction, and the quick wins for marketing Studio.

54

Public API specifications read, in 11 PyPI packages covering 301 operations

128

Recordings transcribed and checked, 121 of them from BlackRock's own channels and partner stages

17x

Projected growth in API calls across BlackRock and Aladdin by 2030, from the 2025 Investor Day

Source: asdk_plugin packages on PyPI[1]; the recordings listed under S in the Source register; BlackRock 2025 Investor Day[2].

What was found. Studio is Aladdin's developer and data layer: APIs and events, a Python SDK on GitHub, and Aladdin Data Cloud on Snowflake, described the same way by five BlackRock speakers since 2024[3, 4, 5, 6]. Proof of use sits in public records: JPMorgan Chase's proxy statements, Janus Henderson's commits and 10-K, Royal London's chief executive on video, and three pension funds' tender notices[7, 8, 9, 10, 11].

What it says about direction. APIs and data access are the growth engine: the fastest-growing measure BlackRock showed investors is API calls[2]. The product is the whole portfolio, public and private, fed through Data Cloud and Explore[12]. AI stays inside the platform while data providers market connectors outside[13, 14]. Buyers tell BlackRock's own webinar they want a core platform plus their own builds[15].

The quick wins. Named proof from clients whose Aladdin relationship is already public; Studio's name on the API growth story; a written one-page version of the spoken message; an RFP-ready API answer; a decision on describing the Copilot plugin model; a "what is in the box" summary. None opens the gate.

What this method can and cannot do

Public material only. BlackRock pages, the 54 specifications inside 11 public `asdk_plugin` packages, 128 recordings (121 from BlackRock's own channels and partner stages), SEC filings, procurement notices, GitHub and PyPI. Part is machine-transcribed, and names and jargon can be mis-heard; the register marks which. Figures may be outdated, and there is no internal product context, so conclusions may be wrong for reasons the author cannot see.

Enterprise gating is expected. Aladdin is enterprise software sold to large institutions, and gating documentation, sandboxes and credentials behind qualification is the normal model for that market; a qualified prospect gets them from BlackRock's solutions team. The right-hand column of Exhibit 6 describes the sequence after qualification, not an absence.

Three corrections already made. 58 specifications became 54 once the SDK's four utility APIs were set aside; a widely repeated "68 percent" survey figure was dropped because it could not be found in the report it is attributed to; "more than 2,000 citizen developers" became 3,000, counted inside BlackRock rather than among clients.

How to read the receipts

Underlined text links to the document behind the fact. Each superscript points to the Source register, which gives the grade, title, speaker and date and, for recordings, the minute and second of each quoted passage.

■ **P** Primary document: a filing, a specification, a page, a notice, GitHub or PyPI

■ **S** BlackRock speaker on the record, with the name and title as given

□ **T** Third-party report: trade press or a secondary summary

Part 1

What the public record shows

Aladdin is the investment platform BlackRock built for itself and sells to other institutions. Its AI engineering lead put the scale this way at a LangChain conference in 2025: "BlackRock is the biggest user of Aladdin, but we also sell and support hundreds of clients globally across 70 countries"; the organization is "around 7,000 people, with over 4,000 of those being engineers," who maintain "around 100 Aladdin front-end applications"[16]. BlackRock's technology services and subscription revenue was $2.0 billion in 2025, up 24 percent with Preqin[17]. It is enterprise software, sold to large institutions through a solutions team; documentation, sandboxes and credentials follow qualification, which is the normal model in that market. BlackRock sells the platform as one engine with separate entry points, and Studio is the entry point for people who write code.

Exhibit 1. One core engine with separate entry points for each kind of buyer

Product	What it does	Main users
Aladdin	The front-to-back system for public markets, the same system BlackRock runs internally[16]	Asset managers, insurers, pension funds, banks
Aladdin Wealth	Portfolio risk analysis and proposals for advisors; its AI "auto commentary" tool launched in October 2025 with Morgan Stanley first[18]	Wealth managers and private banks
eFront	A private fund investment from due diligence through cash flows and reporting; folded Preqin into eFront Insight, with private credit analytics added in May 2026[19]	Investors in funds and fund managers
Aladdin Studio	**The developer and data layer: APIs and events, a Python SDK, Aladdin Compute and Aladdin Data Cloud; "API-first", for "a professional engineer building new workflow applications, a code-curious portfolio manager extracting investment insights, or a data analyst automating reporting"[20]**	**Client engineers, data analysts, code-curious portfolio managers**
Aladdin Data Cloud	A managed data service on Snowflake that puts Aladdin and outside data in one place; sold as an add-on to Aladdin Enterprise[21]; Newman places it "part of Studio"[4]	Data teams
Aladdin Copilot	A chat assistant "now available to all Aladdin clients" that "will not give investment advice"[13]	All platform users
Aladdin Accounting	Investment accounting and performance; the public accounting APIs cover configuration, valuations, lots and composites[1]	Asset managers and asset owners
Aladdin Provider	Connects custodians and administrators into a client's Aladdin; service providers pay BlackRock for its use[22]	Custodians and administrators

Source: BlackRock product pages[20, 13, 23]; Amazon press release, December 2025[21]; iShares prospectus[22]; the public specifications[1].

BlackRock's own definition comes from the head of Studio engineering, on Snowflake's podcast in November 2025. It has three parts.

> "So we think about Aladdin today as a platform and Aladdin Studio is essentially the user experience that allows people to think of Aladdin as a platform. It exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do as a set of APIs events. The Aladdin data cloud built on top of Snowflake takes all of that information that's generated through our analytics factory and inside of Aladdin and pushes that into Snowflake. And increasingly we're building a set of developer tools."
>
> — Dave Woodhead, Managing Director and Head of Engineering for Aladdin Studio, Snowflake Data Cloud podcast, published November 11, 2025[6]

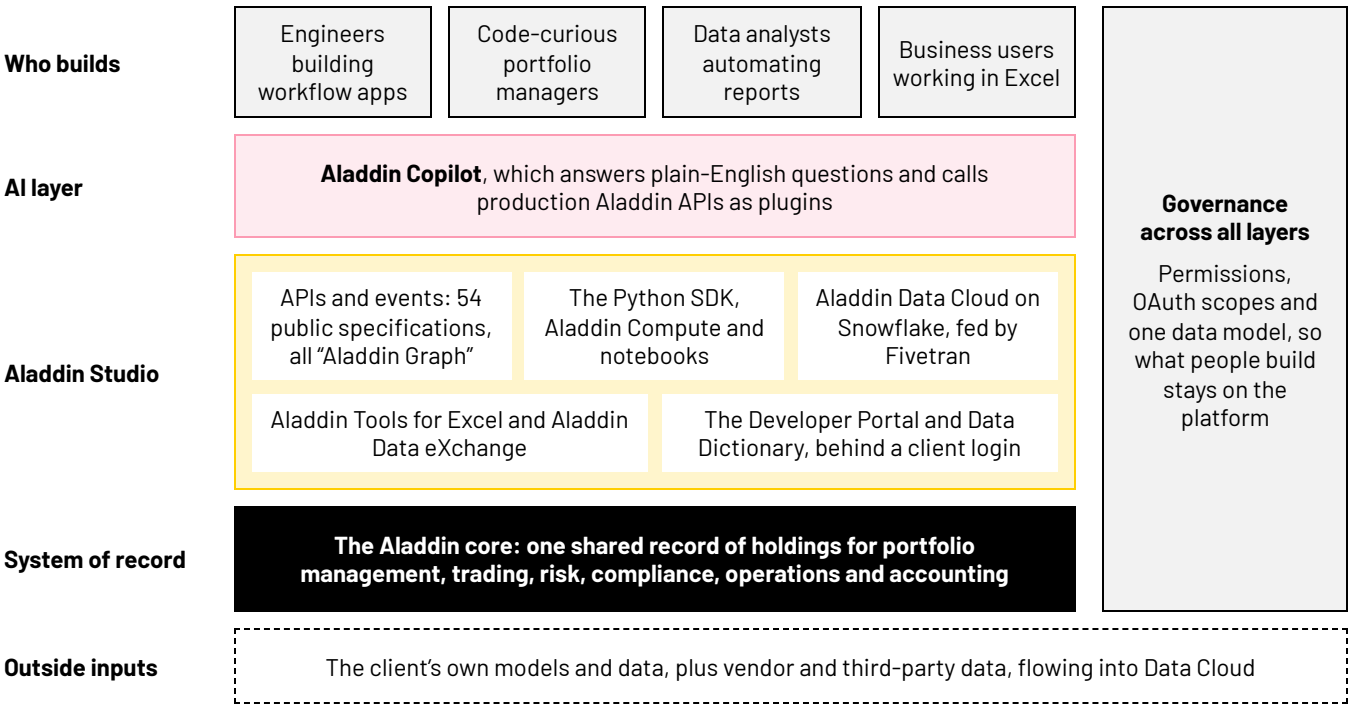
Exhibit 2 follows one trade through that platform, as far as the public specifications describe it: who acts, where BlackRock names a product or application, and which of the 54 APIs covers each step[1, 24].

Exhibit 2. One trade, start to finish: the team, the named application and the public API at each step

Step	Who acts	Named product or application	Public API that covers it
1 **Order**	The portfolio manager: an order is "a directive from a portfolio manager to the trading desk to execute a particular investment decision"[1]	Explore's "new what-if model" compares a changed portfolio with the original before anything is traded[25]; the specifications name no order screen[1]	`OrderAPI` v1, stable: `order:post` takes `whatIf` and `runCompliance`; the status examples run "Open," "Compl Pending," "Authorized," "Active," "Booked"[1]
2 **Compliance check**	Automatic on posting, with `runCompliance` on by default; a violation then carries an owner, a disposition and a resolution comment[1]	Rules "automatically monitor whether a fund adheres to a regulation, client mandate, or internal guideline"; no application is named[1]	`ComplianceRuleAPI` and `ViolationAPI` v1, alpha: violations are "generated at time of the compliance breach," intraday and overnight; a check that times out posts the order as "Compl Pending"[1]
3 **Trade**	The trading desk; operations then confirms, since "after a trade is booked in Aladdin, it needs to be confirmed with broker"[1]	Aladdin Accounting's leads: the run goes "from that first order through the trade, through all the operation protocols into accounting without lifting up the pencil"[24]	`TradeAPI` v2, alpha: `trades:post`, `batchPost`, `filter`; a block trade carries its per-portfolio trades, `confirmedWith` and `confirmedBy`; `BrokerConfirmRoutingAPI` routes the confirm[1]
4 **Position in the IBOR**	The investment team's live book; Newman: "It does start with IBOR"[4]	Aladdin Data Cloud, where users "can access their Investment Books of Record (IBOR), Accounting Books of Record (ABOR) holdings"[26]	No position API among the 54; positions appear as fields (a `PortfolioToolkitAPI` positions source, a violation's "underlying positions"); `CashLadderAPI` v2, stable, gives the settlement-date cash ladder[1]
5 **Lot in the ABOR**	Accounting: "we are data managers more than anything else"[24]	Aladdin Accounting, the product its configuration specification is written for[1]	`AborLotAPI` v1, alpha: ABOR lots "retrieved from the ledger_a_summary table," each with an `aborLotId` and open and close transaction ids; `EnrichedCapitalFlowAPI` v1, stable, posts subscriptions and redemptions[1]
6 **NAV**	Accounting, whose clients are "CFOs, they're controllers, they're heads of performance"[24]	Aladdin Accounting; each valuation carries its own exception list[1]	`ValuationsAPI` v1, beta: valuations "generated for various processes at the portfolio/portfolio group level," with `navLogExceptionRecords` per valuation[1]

■ Source: the public specifications (trading, compliance, investment operations, portfolio, portfolio management, accounting, clients)[1]; Newman[4]; the Explore training recording[25]; the Aladdin Accounting episode[24]; Fivetran[26]. The statuses are the Order specification's examples; the specifications hold no position or event API and do not order steps 4 to 6.

Exhibit 3. Studio sits between the people who build and the system of record



For illustrative purposes only. ■ Source: BlackRock Studio, APIs and Data Cloud pages[20, 27, 23]; the public specifications and SDK README[1, 28]; Woodhead[6]; Rosales and Valdez on the Copilot plugin registry[16].

Exhibit 4. Eight pieces, from read-and-write APIs to an Excel add-in

Piece	What it is, in plain words
APIs (Aladdin Graph)	Defined ways for a program to read and write Aladdin data. Every public specification carries an id of the form `agraph.<domain>.<segment>.<group>.v1.<API>`, so Aladdin Graph is the whole API layer, not one API[1]. The APIs page says there are "dozens," with more added regularly[27]. The 54 public specs include orders, trades, compliance rules, risk rules, security creation and ADC datasets[1].
Event-driven APIs	Aladdin tells a program when something happens instead of the program asking. Woodhead names "APIs events" as one pillar[6]; Goel's target is "every single transaction … via an event, via an API"[5]. No event specification is in the public packages[1].
Aladdin Data Cloud	A managed data store on Snowflake, with Fivetran moving the data; Goel gives the latency as "within 15 minutes"[5]. Woodhead: "hundreds of Snowflake accounts … tens of thousands of pipelines"[6].
Aladdin Compute	A hosted space where developers run Python next to their Aladdin data; the SDK has a run mode for "Aladdin Studio Compute sessions"[28].
Aladdin SDK	An open-source Python library that handles login, retries, rate limits, pagination and long-running operations[28]. Eleven add-on packages, one per domain, are generated from the specifications by the plugin builder[29].
Investment research	A domain of five alpha APIs: research notes, engagements, analyst coverage, watchlists and screening criteria[1].
Aladdin Tools for Excel	An Excel add-in listed on the APIs page as a Studio resource, with Aladdin Data eXchange for bulk delivery; little public detail[27].
Developer Portal and Data Dictionary	The API catalog, framework guides, field dictionary, notebooks and code samples the APIs page describes. All sit behind a client login[27].

■ Source: BlackRock Studio and APIs pages[20, 27]; the 54 public specifications and SDK README[1, 28]; Woodhead[6] and Goel[5].

Exhibit 5. The public catalog: 54 specifications across 11 domains

Domain	Specs	Operations	Alpha	Beta	Stable	Sunset	Largest APIs by operations
Investment operations	15	**74**	9	4	2	–	PrincipalInterestFactor, CounterPartySettlementInstruction, MiscellaneousCashflow, CouponReset and 11 more
Analytics	9	**53**	–	–	8	1	RiskRule, RiskWorkflow, RiskException, RiskConfig and 5 more
Investment research	5	**41**	5	–	–	–	AnalystCoverage, Criterion, Watchlist, ResearchNote and 1 more
Platform	6	**29**	2	–	4	–	AdcDataset, UserGroup, User, UserGroupPermission and 2 more
Portfolio management	4	**28**	1	–	3	–	CIDWriter, Strategy, CIDReader, CashLadder
Portfolio	3	**23**	1	–	2	–	PortfolioGroup, RestrictedAsset, PortfolioToolkit
Data	1	**15**	–	–	1	–	SecurityCreation
Trading	2	**14**	1	–	1	–	Order, Trade
Compliance	4	**9**	3	–	1	–	ComplianceRuleAssignment, Violation, ComplianceRule, Level
Accounting	4	**8**	2	2	–	–	PortfolioConfiguration, Valuations, CompositeMembership, AborLot
Clients	1	**7**	–	–	1	–	EnrichedCapitalFlow
Total	**54**	**301**	**24**	**6**	**23**	**1**	11 domains, 11 PyPI packages

■ Source: the 54 Swagger 2.0 specifications inside the 11 `asdk_plugin` packages, version 2.0.0b3, on PyPI[1]. Counts recomputed by the author from the files. The core `aladdinsdk` package adds four utility APIs (token, subscription, notification and a demo), which are not counted here.

The specifications say more than their count. Every one is tagged `Access.Internal`, a label BlackRock does not explain in public[1]. Posting an order takes `whatIf` and `runCompliance`, which defaults to true, and returns compliance violations inline[1]. Ten specifications expose a long-running-operations endpoint and 35 operations are flagged for it; the SDK polls them[28]. Risk exceptions and ADC datasets carry bitemporal fields; rule assignments and dataset releases name a four-eyes approval[1]. Every request carries an application key plus OAuth 2.0 scopes such as `trading.order_management.order.v1.Order:read`, and the client ID and secret come from the Studio UI[28].

What is out there before a conversation starts

Exhibit 6 follows a prospect's engineer through six steps, from first hearing about Studio to getting help, and records what is out there at each step and what follows qualification. A qualified prospect gets documentation, a sandbox and credentials through BlackRock's solutions team; the right-hand column is that sequence, not a gap.

The SDK is the one piece that installs before any conversation. It has had 14 releases since May 2024, all alpha or beta, with the core at 2.0.0b10 in July 2026 and the add-ons at 2.0.0b3[30, 1]. Each release pins an old Snowflake library, so none installs on Python 3.13, and the SDK's dependencies conflict with the official MCP toolkit; an outside fix was merged in August 2026 and has not shipped[31]. The README documents three run modes, "a developer's local machine," "Aladdin Studio Compute sessions" and a test mode, stores a prompted password in the operating system's credential manager, and carries settings for firms that consume "the Aladdin APIs via an enterprise API management platform such as Azure API Management"[28]. These are the needs of a client's engineering team.

Exhibit 6. Six steps a prospect's developer takes, before and after qualification

Step	Out there today	After qualification	Receipt
Hear	Podcasts, webinar replays, client videos and conference talks on BlackRock's site and partner channels	Client forums and the solutions team	Never Done[32], Big Little Questions[33], Woodhead[6], Rosales and Valdez[16]
Read	The Studio page: "Create & automate," "Make Aladdin your own," "Align internally & externally"; the APIs page: "dozens of APIs"	The Developer Portal and the API framework guides	Studio page[20], APIs page[27]
See the catalog	54 specifications, by unpacking the 11 PyPI add-on packages	The API catalog and the Data Dictionary	asdk_plugin packages[1], APIs page[27]
Try	Nothing to run: no public sandbox or trial is offered	Studio Compute, an API token or OAuth application "registered via Studio UI," the client's Aladdin host	SDK README[28]
Build	The open-source SDK on GitHub and PyPI, with a detailed README; the plugin builder	Every call: the SDK needs a client host and credentials	SDK README[28], PyPI history[30], plugin builder[29]
Get help	GitHub issues and pull requests on the SDK, answered by BlackRock engineers; "Book a meeting" and "Download the brochure"	Notebooks, code samples, support	Pull request 52[8], pull request 57[31], Studio page[20]

Source: the pages and repositories in the Receipt column, read with no account or login, October 2026; the right-hand column is what they say a client receives, not tested.

Exhibit 7. Several access models coexist in this market: what a developer with no client relationship can reach, on eight criteria

2: Fully public or self-serve 1: Partial or after signup or approval 0: None or blocked

Platform	Public docs	API catalog	Trial or sandbox	First call as a non-client	Sample code	Community or marketplace	AI connector	Call to action	Total
Investment platforms									
Bloomberg	1	0	1	1	1	0	0	1	**5**
Aladdin Studio	**1**	**1**	**0**	**0**	**1**	**1**	**0**	**0**	**4**
State Street	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	1	**4**
Arcesium	0	0	0	0	0	1	2	0	**3**
SimCorp	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	**1**
Clearwater	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	**1**
Data and cloud platforms									
Snowflake	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	**16**
Databricks	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	**16**
LSEG	1	2	1	1	2	2	2	1	**12**
FactSet	2	2	0	0	2	1	2	0	**9**
MSCI	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	0	**2**

For the AI connector, 2 means an MCP server or connector that outside AI tools can use, 1 one announced or in limited release, and 0 none, or an assistant that works only inside the vendor's own platform.

Source: the author's test of each platform's public pages[20, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41], no accounts or payments, October 8, 2026. Bloomberg, Clearwater and MSCI may be underrated: some pages blocked automated access.

Exhibit 7 puts Studio beside ten platforms a Studio buyer also deals with, on eight things a developer with no client relationship can reach[34, 35, 36]. Investment platforms mostly gate: documentation, a sandbox and a first call follow a relationship, at Aladdin as at Bloomberg, State Street, SimCorp, Clearwater and Arcesium. Data and cloud platforms, which sell to developers directly, mostly self-serve. Only Studio, among the investment platforms, offers an open-source SDK[28]. The exhibit shows each vendor's model, not a score against Aladdin.

Five BlackRock speakers define Studio on the record in the 128 recordings pulled for this document, with the titles the recordings give[32, 33].

Exhibit 8. The five BlackRock speakers who define Studio on the record

Speaker	Title, as given	What they add	Where
Dave Woodhead	Managing Director and Head of Engineering for Aladdin Studio	The three-pillar definition; 3,000 internal citizen developers	Snowflake podcast, Nov 2025[6]
Richard Newman	General Manager, Aladdin Studio	Data Cloud is "part of Studio"; analytics APIs "releasing soon … all part of the Studio umbrella"	Never Done, Jan 2025[4]
Diwakar Goel	Global Head of Data, Aladdin	Every transaction "via an event, via an API"; Data Cloud "within 15 minutes of latency"	Pensions webinar, 2025[5]
Kunal Khara	Managing Director and Global Head of Aladdin Product	"The Aladdin studio estate" as a 2024 focus: programmatic access "at machine scale"	Awards interview, early 2024[3]
Jeff Miller	Managing Director, Global Head of Data Platform and Product Engineering	Data Cloud replaced "flat files … FTP and related transfers"	Snowflake video, undated[42]

Source: the recordings cited in the Where column. Quotations are verbatim from the transcripts; three of the five are machine transcriptions, marked in the register.

Four of them describe Studio with the same three parts: Woodhead names them outright[6]; Newman places Data Cloud "part of Studio"[4]; Goel describes events, APIs and a near-real-time data store[5]; Khara calls it programmatic access to data and reporting[3]. A 2026 job posting calls Studio "Aladdin's extensibility layer"[43]. The message is consistent across speakers and years, so the positioning exists. Learning about Studio from outside takes effort: the catalog is unpacked from packages, the definitions transcribed from recordings, and nothing can be run; that fits how Aladdin is sold, through a solutions team to qualified institutions, after a conversation.

Exhibit 9. Four BlackRock speakers, 2024 to 2025, and the three pillars each names

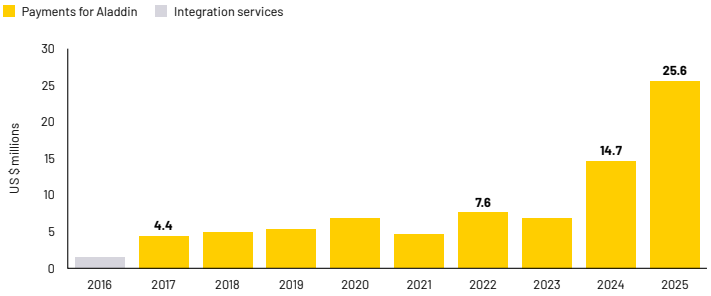
Speaker, date	What they said	APIs and events	Data Cloud	Developer tools
Kunal Khara, early 2024	"More users are craving this ability to interact with our data, with their data, with reporting with dashboards on a programmatic basis"[3]	**Yes**	**Yes**	–
Richard Newman, Jan 2025	"The Aladdin data cloud … which is part of Studio"; "those analytic APIs … That's all part of the Studio umbrella"[4]	**Yes**	**Yes**	–
Diwakar Goel, 2025	"Every single transaction … via an event, via an API"; "a near real time data store"; exposing "the software and application that we're building"[5]	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**
Dave Woodhead, Nov 2025	"It exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do as a set of APIs events. The Aladdin data cloud built on top of Snowflake … developer tools"[6]	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**

Source: the four recordings cited[3, 4, 5, 6]. Quotations are verbatim; Khara, Goel and Woodhead are machine or auto-caption transcriptions, marked in the register.

1. Public customer proof already exists, and it is viable even though it is not Studio-specific

BlackRock's Studio page names no client as building on Studio[20], and a full-text search of SEC EDGAR finds no filing that mentions it[44]. Proof of Aladdin in use is public all the same. On BlackRock's own client video, Royal London's chief executive credits the Snowflake implementation[10]. JPMorgan Chase reports its Aladdin payments in its proxy statement every year: $4.4 million to $7.6 million from 2017 to 2023, then $14.7 million in 2024 and $25.6 million in 2025[45, 7].

Exhibit 10. JPMorgan Chase payments to BlackRock for Aladdin, US$ millions



Source: JPMorgan Chase proxy statements (DEF 14A), filed 2017 to 2026, by year of payment[45, 7]. The payments may include more than a client license: JPMorgan is also a custodian, and in 2016 it said it was connecting to Aladdin to serve custody clients on the platform[46]; that report is trade press, not a JPMorgan or BlackRock document.

In December 2025 a Janus Henderson engineer submitted two changes to the open-source SDK, URL rewriting and custom headers, for firms that route Aladdin calls through an enterprise gateway; the BlackRock engineer who co-wrote the SDK's launch post merged them, and the commits carry a janushenderson.com author line[8, 47, 48, 49]. Janus Henderson's 10-K says the firm chose in the third quarter of 2025 to move its investment management system to Aladdin, "a complex, multi-year initiative"[9]. Public buyers add a third record: procurement notices that score the bids.

Exhibit 11. Public buyers that scored Aladdin bids

Buyer	Year	Scoring	Outcome
UK Pension Protection Fund[11]	2025	Technical 85, price 6, price sensitivity 6, contract terms 3	Aladdin won both lots, above the fund's own price estimate
Nest (UK)[50]	2023	Quality 70, cost 20, social value 10	Aladdin won against six other bids
US Pension Benefit Guaranty Corporation[51]	2017 and 2023	Full and open competition, four bids each time	BlackRock won both; the 2023 rebid kept the same price

Source: UK Find a Tender[11, 50]; USAspending.gov[51]. Weights and outcomes are from an earlier draft of this research (October 2026) and its reading of the notices, not re-pulled; the 2023 PBGC record was re-read on October 19, 2026.

None of this is Studio-specific, and that matters less than it looks. Studio is sold for custom applications on Aladdin, and a buyer wants to know that another institution built on the platform and stayed; in custom-application land, proof from one firm counts even for a dissimilar buyer. Public pension funds, and firms whose filings or tenders already name BlackRock, can go public more easily, and are the natural first candidates for a named Studio story.

> **What it suggests about direction.** Adoption is growing in client types whose records are public: a bank's proxy statement, an asset manager's 10-K and three pension funds' notices all record Aladdin between 2023 and 2025. Named proof for Studio can start where the relationship is already on the record.

2. BlackRock's growth story is API consumption and the whole portfolio, and Studio is the vehicle even when it is not named

At its 2025 Investor Day, BlackRock projected that API calls across BlackRock and Aladdin would grow 17 times by 2030, against four times for model portfolios, two times for portfolios and 1.3 times for trade allocations; the slide gave no starting number[2]. API use is the activity the Studio page describes[20]. The investor story is told without the product's name. Across 26 earnings calls from the first quarter of 2020 to the second quarter of 2026, no executive said "Studio"[52]; a single line on a 2023 Investor Day slide is the only other investor mention found[53]. BlackRock's 10-K says technology services fees are generally set by the value of positions on the platform or at a fixed rate, and can depend on subscriptions, go-lives and support; API calls appear in none of those terms[17, 2]. Exhibit 12 is an observation about how the story is told.

Exhibit 12. Mentions of Studio terms on 26 BlackRock earnings calls, Q1 2020 to Q2 2026

Term	Mentions	Context
Studio	**0**	**One line on a 2023 Investor Day slide is the only other investor mention found[53]**
Data Cloud	2	Q3 2022[54] and Q4 2024[55], as an add-on sold with Aladdin Enterprise
API	1	Q4 2021: "clients are really looking to use both data and APIs"[56]
Copilot	1	Q4 2023: "investments in Aladdin AI copilots"[57]
Citizen developer	0	Never
Agent	0	Never

Source: third-party transcripts of BlackRock earnings calls, Q1 2020 to Q2 2026[52]. Counts are the author's tally. Zero counts are reliable; other counts are approximate.

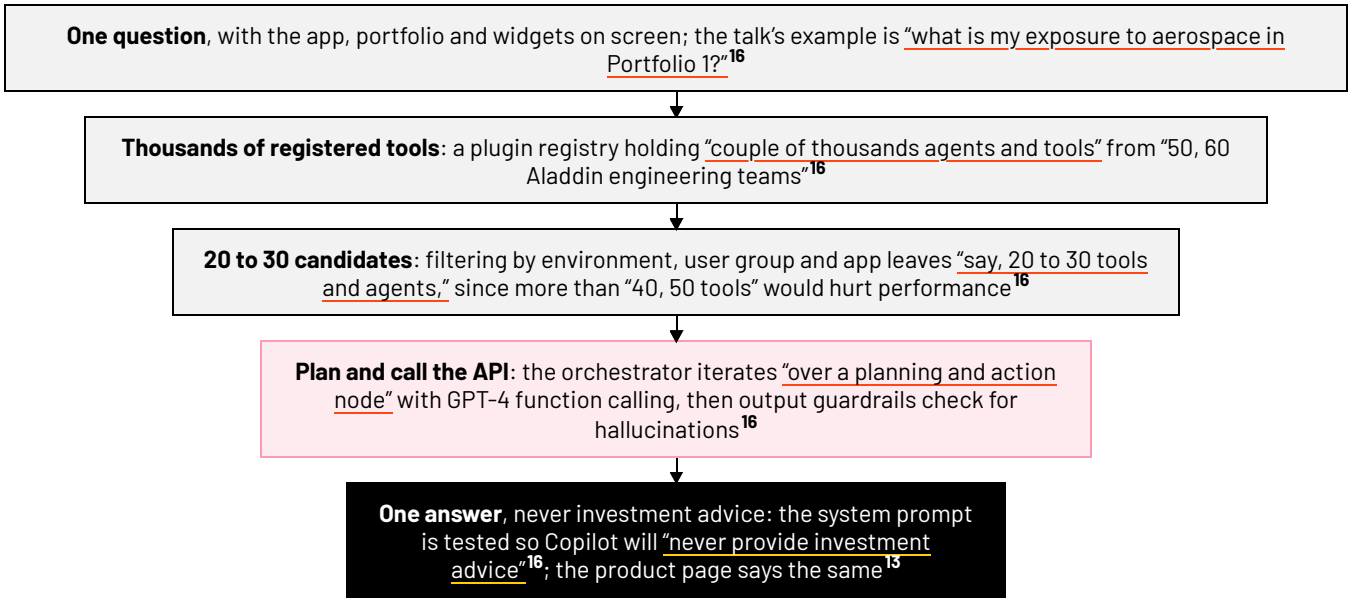
The other half of the growth story is the whole portfolio. BlackRock bought eFront in 2019 and Preqin in 2025, and in September 2025 its private markets team described the result on a client webinar: investors "now have access to over 15,000 fund investments within eFront Insight" for benchmarking; Preqin indices "are also available today in Aladdin Explore and our Aladdin Data Cloud capabilities"; and "over 10 different transaction types" were added to Aladdin, across commitments, fundings, pay-downs and PIK, so private credit loans are captured natively, designed with BlackRock's own professionals and "our new colleagues from HPS"[12]. Private credit analytics on Preqin followed in May 2026[19]. Newman lists eFront data and Preqin among what is joining Data Cloud[4]. Hosting moved the same way: Microsoft wrote in December 2024 that all BlackRock's technology platform clients and services are hosted in the Azure cloud, with new rollouts taking "weeks instead of quarters"[58], and in December 2025 BlackRock and AWS announced a second option, with general availability for US-hosted Aladdin Enterprise clients expected in the second half of 2026[21].

> **What it suggests about direction.** Extensibility and data access are where BlackRock itself says growth is. The fastest-growing measure it showed investors is API calls, and the data it is adding, private markets and Preqin, arrives through Data Cloud and Explore, which are Studio's surfaces. Studio is the vehicle for that story whether or not the name appears.

3. BlackRock has built an AI front door and keeps it inside the platform, while data providers market theirs outside

Aladdin Copilot is "now available to all Aladdin clients" and "will not give investment advice or respond to questions outside Aladdin platform boundaries"[13]. Its engineers describe a plugin registry with "couple of thousands agents and tools", where the first way a team onboards is "to define a tool as kind of mapping one-to-one to an existing Aladdin API already out in production"[16]. Copilot's tools are Studio's APIs; Microsoft's Adrian Crockett put it in one line on BlackRock's podcast: "There's no copilot without plug-ins"[59]. BlackRock's AI product head says the team is making sure "the data model itself is structured for agentic use cases"[60].

Exhibit 13. How Aladdin Copilot answers a question



Source: Rosales and Valdez at LangChain Interrupt 2025[16], the Copilot page[13]. The tool counts are the speakers' own approximations; the talk is a machine transcription, marked in the register.

Outside the login, the data market has chosen the other model. MCP is the common standard AI assistants use to pull data from other systems[61]. Seven providers a Studio buyer also talks to offer a connector or an MCP server; LSEG had 90 customers connected by April 2026, according to a secondary summary of its results slides[62, 63]. No public connector for Aladdin was found on BlackRock's pages or GitHub[20, 64]; a Forward Deploy Engineer posting for Aladdin Data names "Model Context Protocol (MCP), AI agents, and Copilot extensions"[65].

Exhibit 14. Seven data and platform providers let outside AI tools pull their data; no public Aladdin equivalent was found

Provider	What is public	Receipt
FactSet	An MCP server for its data, which FactSet calls the first in its market	FactSet press release[14]
LSEG	A collaboration with Anthropic and an MCP server; 90 customers connected by April 2026	LSEG press release[63]; Investing.com summary[62]
MSCI	"AI connectors" to its proprietary data	MSCI press release[41]
Arcesium	AI features in Aquata, and an AI platform announcement	Arcesium press releases[66, 40]

Provider	What is public	Receipt
S&P Global	Credit Ratings added to its AI Data Portal, September 2026	S&P Global press release[67]
Snowflake	A documented MCP server for Cortex Agents	Snowflake documentation[68]
Databricks	Managed MCP servers, documented	Databricks documentation[69]
Aladdin	**None found. A Forward Deploy Engineer posting for Aladdin Data names "Model Context Protocol (MCP), AI agents, and Copilot extensions"**	**BlackRock Careers**[65]

■ Source: the press releases, documentation and job posting in the Receipt column, as of October 2026. The LSEG customer count is from a secondary summary[62].

Exhibit 15. Two sides of the AI front door

	Inside the login: Copilot plugins on production APIs	Outside the login: a connector or MCP server for the buyer's own AI tools
For	Governance in one place; inherited permissions ("permission-dependent access"); no-advice guardrails tested in the system prompt; enterprise trust; a controlled rollout team by team[13, 16]	Discoverability; developer pull; an ecosystem signal; a ready answer to the RFP question about connectors; the terms FactSet, LSEG and MSCI now set[14, 63, 41, 15]
Against	Invisible to prospects and to the AI tools buyers already use; rivals set the terms of comparison; the plugin model is described only in a conference talk[16]	A larger security surface; support cost; a partial catalog exposed and read as the whole; regulatory optics for a platform that will not give advice[13]

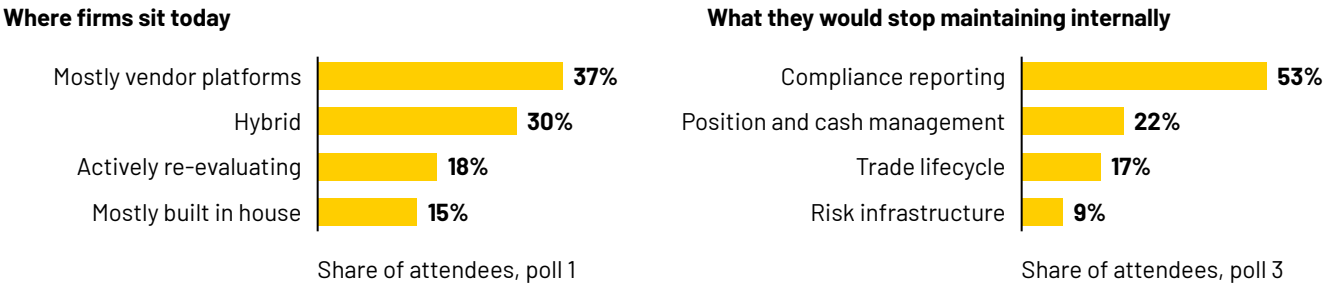
■ Source: the author's reading of the Copilot page[13], the LangChain talk[16], the provider announcements in Exhibit 14 and the Build vs. Buy webinar[15].

What it suggests about direction. The choice is deliberate and consistent with the governance message: permission-dependent access, content filtering, no investment advice. The open question is timing and description, not access: when BlackRock describes how clients' own AI tools will reach Aladdin, and in what words, while rivals set the terms of that comparison.

4. Buyers say they want a core platform plus their own builds, and rivals are selling to that

BlackRock's own Build vs. Buy webinar polled its attendees. In the first poll, 37 percent said they run "mostly vendor platforms," 30 percent "hybrid," 18 percent were "actively reevaluating" and 15 percent were "mostly built in house"[15]. Asked what is driving the decision, "AI and data demands" led at 42 percent, with cost and speed to market tied behind it[15]. Asked what they would stop maintaining internally, 53 percent chose compliance reporting[15]. The host read from the slide that 60 to 70 percent of technology cost sits in "maintenance of current systems," and the Alpha FMC panellist said a transformation runs "roughly 12 to 18 months"[15].

Exhibit 16. What attendees of BlackRock's Build vs. Buy webinar said



Source: poll results as read out on the Build vs. Buy webinar replay, published captions[15]. Attendee counts were not stated. Poll 2, on what is driving the decision, put "AI and data demands" at 42 percent, with cost and speed to market tied.

> "What's the API suite that you have? Are you using connectors to Snowflake or to Databricks? And I think that that part of the RFP has become much more prominent."
>
> — Clark Schafer, Partner, Alpha FMC, on the Build vs. Buy webinar[15]

BlackRock's head of solutions engineering for the Americas answered on the same webinar. "That word monolith is definitely being challenged in the market," she said; the shift of the last two years is "to more of a modular approach where clients are looking for that backbone foundational data that supports both publics and privates workflows," with "very, very robust APIs that manage the end to end life cycle of a transaction" so that clients can build "their secret sauce rebalancing tools" on top[15]. On AI, "you need that system of record that underpins anything that AI is built upon," and "the other layer that is almost equally important is a really defined system of work"[15]. Rivals are selling to the same buyer. SimCorp announced wins at AllianceBernstein in February 2026 and Pictet in May 2026; AllianceBernstein keeps its "specialized in-house technology," and Pictet connects its own tools to SimCorp One by API[70, 71]. BlackRock's August 2026 insight says "Build vs buy is no longer a binary question"[72].

> **What it suggests about direction.** Extensibility is now an RFP question, asked in those words, and Studio is BlackRock's answer: the APIs, events and Data Cloud that Sewdass describes are the pieces in Exhibit 4. The buyer's question and the product already match. The quick wins put the answer where the buyer is asking.

Part 3

Based on this, the quick wins in marketing Studio

Each quick win uses what is already public or already true inside BlackRock, works inside the enterprise selling model, and changes nothing about what a prospect can access. None opens the gate: documentation, sandboxes and credentials stay with the solutions team, after qualification. Product owns what is built and when; marketing owns positioning, stories and sales material; compliance checks the final version.

Exhibit 17. Quick wins

Quick win	Why	What it takes	Owner	Measure
A named-proof programme, starting where the relationship is already public	Finding 1	Shortlist clients whose Aladdin relationship is on the record: tender winners (the Pension Protection Fund, Nest, PBGC), filers (JPMorgan Chase, Janus Henderson) and Royal London, which is already on video[11, 7, 9, 10]. Ask each for one Studio-specific sentence or one build. Accept proof from a dissimilar firm; a pension fund's story serves an insurer	Marketing, with the client business for introductions	Named references in use; deals in which one was cited
Studio's name on the API growth story	Finding 2	Agree one measure with investor relations and product, built on the API-call projection[2], and put Studio's name beside it in investor and client materials	Product with investor relations; marketing writes the story	Studio named beside the measure in the next investor and client decks
A written one-page version of the spoken message	Part 1	Turn the three-part definition four speakers already give[6, 4, 5, 3] into one written page, reviewed by product and compliance, used in every deck and page	Marketing	One page adopted; no deck or page that contradicts it
An RFP-ready "API suite" answer for qualified buyers	Finding 4	A document that answers the question Schafer says buyers now ask[15]: the domains, counts and status of the catalog, connectors to Snowflake and Databricks, how clients build on top. Delivered by the solutions team after qualification	Solutions engineering, with marketing	Time to answer the API question in an RFP; RFPs in which it is used
A decision on when and how to describe the Copilot plugin model publicly	Finding 3	A description, not access: how Copilot's tools map to production APIs[16], what governance applies[13], and how clients will connect their own AI tools, timed with the Forward Deploy Engineer work[65]	Product with marketing; compliance review	A public description exists; prospects stop asking the question in rivals' words
A prospect-facing "what is in the box" summary	Part 1	One page listing the 11 domains with counts and status, as in Exhibit 5[1], with no specifications; shared before the first meeting or on the Studio page	Marketing, with product	First meetings that start past scope; prospects who arrive with the list

Source: the author's proposals, built on Part 1 and Findings 1 to 4. Receipts in the table point to the public facts each win rests on.

What I would need from inside

Five questions need internal data that no public source holds. The answers would confirm or correct the findings before any of the wins is sized.

Exhibit 18. Five questions for internal data

Question	What the answer would decide
How many clients have active API credentials or a Data Cloud instance, and how has that changed since 2024?	The baseline for every measure in Exhibit 17
Which clients would agree to be named, and what usually stops them?	How soon the named-proof programme can start
What does the `Access.Internal` tag on every public specification mean, and does it limit what can be described without a login?	What the "what is in the box" summary may say
How will clients connect their own AI tools to Aladdin, and is the Forward Deploy Engineer work the path?	The timing of the Copilot description
Where does adoption stall most: awareness, the first API call, or getting a build into production?	Where marketing spends first: content, enablement or client success

Source: the author's questions. Question 3 refers to the tag on the public specifications[1]; question 4 to the job posting that names MCP[65].

On method: AI agents pulled the pages, unpacked the packages, transcribed the recordings and drafted; the author checked each claim against the document or recording it cites and takes responsibility for the reading. Public sources are limited, can be out of date and carry no internal product context, and machine transcription and synthesis are imperfect. The conclusions may be wrong for reasons the author cannot see, and the five questions above are where that would show first.

Source register

Numbered in order of first citation and grouped by grade. P is a primary document; S is a BlackRock speaker on the record, with the name and title as the recording gives them; T is a third-party report. "Machine transcription" means a local transcription of the downloaded audio; "auto-captions" means YouTube's captions. In both, names and jargon can be mis-heard, and only caption misspellings of proper names were corrected inside quotations. For recordings, the entry gives the minute and second at which each quoted passage begins.

P. Primary documents

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22 P **iShares V plc prospectus (Aladdin Provider fees paid by service providers)**. BlackRock, 2026. https://www.blackrock.com/uk/literature/prospectus/ishares-v-plc-prospectus-en.pdf

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28 P **AladdinSDK README and source, blackrock/aladdinsdk**. GitHub, as of October 19, 2026. https://github.com/blackrock/aladdinsdk

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S. BlackRock speakers on the record

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4 S **Data: the key ingredient (Never Done podcast, with Snowflake; published transcript)**. Richard Newman, General Manager, Aladdin Studio, BlackRock, January 8, 2025. https://www.blackrock.com/aladdin/discover/podcast/snowflake-podcast-data-the-key-ingredient Quoted at 0:23, 1:32, 1:54, 2:00.

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T. Third-party reports

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About this document

Independent analysis compiled from public sources: BlackRock product pages, SEC filings, procurement notices, public code and packages on GitHub and PyPI, press releases, job postings, and transcripts of BlackRock recordings. It was not produced, reviewed or endorsed by BlackRock.

AI agents pulled the pages, unpacked the packages, transcribed the recordings and drafted the text. The author checked each claim against the document or recording it cites. Public material is limited, can be out of date and carries no internal product context; machine transcription and synthesis are imperfect; the conclusions may be wrong for reasons the author cannot see.

Facts are as of October 19, 2026, unless an exhibit gives another date. Underlined text links to the document behind each fact. Superscripts point to the Source register, which gives the grade, the title, the speaker and the date of every source.

Three corrections were made against earlier drafts of this research: 58 API specifications became 54 once the SDK's four utility APIs were set aside; a widely repeated "68 percent" survey figure was dropped because it could not be found in the report it is attributed to; and "more than 2,000 citizen developers" became 3,000, counted inside BlackRock rather than among clients.

The quick wins and questions in Part 3 are the author's proposals, based on Part 1 and the findings in Part 2.

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